

Employment

- 2020-present Assistant Professor in the Department of Information, Risk and Operations Management at the McCombs School of Business at The University of Texas at Austin
- Core member in the Machine Learning Laboratory at UT Austin
 - Affiliated faculty at Oden Institute for Computational Engineering and Sciences at UT Austin
 - Research affiliate, Misinformation & AI at UT Austin
 - Research affiliate at the MIT Media Lab
- 2025-present Courtesy Faculty in the Department of Computer Science at The University of Texas at Austin
- 2024-present Courtesy Faculty in the School of Information at The University of Texas at Austin

Education

- Ph.D. Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Cambridge, MA, USA**
2017-2020 MIT Media Lab, Human Dynamics Group
- Master of Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Cambridge, MA, USA**
Science Computer Science at Electrical Engineering and Computer Science Department
2013-2016
- Master of Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Cambridge, MA, USA**
Science Transportation Engineering at Civil and Environmental Engineering Department
2013-2016

Journals

- [1] **Yan Leng**, Yunxin Sang, and Ashish Agarwal. Reducing Disparity Between LLMs and Humans: Optimal LLM Sample Calibration. Accepted, *Marketing Science*.
- [2] **Yan Leng**, Yijun Chen, Xiaowen Dong, Junfeng Wu, and Guodong Shi. When Behavioral Data Betray Users: A Diagnostic and Protective Framework Against Social Interaction Leakages. *Information Systems Research* (2026).
- [3] **Yan Leng** (lead author), Xiao Liu, Rodrigo Ruiz. Interpretable Recommendations and Parameter-Grounded Explanations with Multi-Graph Attention. Accepted, *Information Systems Research*.
- [4] **Yan Leng*** and Yuan Yuan*. SUVA: A Probabilistic Framework for Auditing LLMs with an Application to Social Preferences. *Information Systems Research* (2026).
- [5] Sandro Lera* and **Yan Leng***. Beyond Pairwise Network Interactions: Implications for Information Centrality. *Information Systems Research* (2025).
- [6] Junyu Cao* and **Yan Leng***. Adaptive Data Acquisition for Personalized Recommendations with Optimality Guarantees on Short-Form Video Platforms. *Management Science* (2025).
- [7] **Yan Leng** and Drew Dimmery. Calibration of Heterogeneous Treatment Effects in Randomized Experiments. *Information Systems Research* (2024).
- [8] Lei Wang, Kemi Ding, **Yan Leng**, Xiaoqiang Ren and Guodong Shi. Private Nash Equilibrium Seeking in Quadratic Network Game. *IEEE Transactions on Control of Network Systems* (2024).
- [9] **Yan Leng**, Xiaowen Dong, Esteban Moro, and Alex Pentland. Long-Range Social Influence in Phone Communication Networks on Offline Adoption Decisions. *Information Systems Research* (2023).
- [10] **Yan Leng**, Tara Sowriraja, Yujia Zhai, and Alex Pentland. Measuring Social Influence Within and Across Multi-dimensional Homophilous Communities. *IEEE Transactions on Knowledge and Data Engineering* (2023).

- [11] **Yan Leng***, Dominiquo Santistevan*, and Alex Pentland. Understanding Collective Regularity in Human Mobility as a Familiar Stranger Phenomenon. *Scientific Reports* (2021).
- [12] **Yan Leng**, Yujia Zhai, Shaojing Sun, Yifei Wu, Jordan Selzer, Sharon Strover, Anfan Chen, Hezhao Zhang, and Ying Ding. Analysis of Misinformation During the COVID-19 Outbreak in China: Cultural, Social and Political Entanglements. *IEEE Transactions on Big Data* (2021).
- [13] **Yan Leng**, Yehonatan Yella, Rodrigo Ruiz, and Alex Pentland. Contextual Centrality: Going Beyond Network Structure. *Scientific Reports* (2020).
- [14] Xiaobing Liu, Xuedong Yan, Feng Liu, Rui Wang, and **Yan Leng**. A Trip-specific Model for Fuel Saving Estimation and Subsidy Policy Making of Carpooling Based on Empirical Data. *Applied Energy* (2019).
- [15] Shaokuan Chen, **Yan Leng**, Baohua Mao, and Shuang Liu. Integrated Weight-based Multi-criteria Evaluation on Transfer in Large Transport Terminals: A Case Study of the Beijing South Railway Station. *Transportation Research Part A: Policy and Practice* (2014).

* Equal contribution.

Refereed CS Conference

- [1] **Yan Leng*** and Trung Nguyen*. Latent Neural Coupling of Risk and Time Preferences in LLMs Mirrors Human Biases. *EC '25: Proceedings of the 26th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation*, 2025.
- [2] Yuanpei Gao, Qi Yan, **Yan Leng**, Renjie Liao. Neural MJD: Neural Non-Stationary Merton Jump Diffusion for Time Series Prediction. *Proceedings of the 39th Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems*, 2025.
- [3] **Yan Leng**. Can LLMs Mimic Human-Like Mental Accounting and Behavioral Biases? *EC '24: Proceedings of the 25th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation*, 2024
- [4] Xue Yu, Muchen Li, **Yan Leng**, Renjie Liao. Learning Latent Structures in Network Games via Data-Dependent Gated-Prior Graph Variational Autoencoders. *Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2024.
- [5] Emanuele Rossi, Federico Monti, **Yan Leng**, Michael Bronstein and Xiaowen Dong. Learning to Infer Structures of Network Games. *Proceedings of the 39th International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2022.
- [6] **Yan Leng**, Xiaowen Dong, Junfeng Wu, and Alex Pentland. Learning Quadratic Games on Networks. *Proceedings of the 37th International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2020.

Revisions

- [1] Christina Jeong, Jason Chan, **Yan Leng**, and Yue Guo. Dynamic Latent-State Centrality for Enterprise Social Media: Predicting Sales Performance from Multiplex Communication. Conditional acceptance, *Information Systems Research*.
- [2] **Yan Leng**, Yunxin Sang, Dahai Yu, Binwu Wang, Yang Wang, and Guang Wang. FusionTransNet for Smart Urban Mobility: Spatiotemporal Traffic Forecasting Through Multimodal Network Integration. Minor revision, *Management Science*.
- [3] **Yan Leng**. LLMs' Human-Like Behavioral Biases Emerge from Linear Neural Representations. Revise and resubmit at *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)*.
- [4] Junyu Cao*, **Yan Leng***, and Hao Wang*. Revenue-Centered Delivery Time Presentation on Platforms: A Spatial Neural ODE Approach. First-round major revision, *Management Science*.
- [5] **Yan Leng**. When Prompts Matter: Quantifying Prompt Uncertainty and Improving Empirical Inference with LLM-Based Measurement. Major revision, *Management Science*.
- [6] **Yan Leng***, Ernest Liu*, Yifei Ren*, and Aleh Tsyvinski*. The Bullwhip: Time-to-Build and Sectoral Fluctuations. Revise and resubmit, *Journal of Political Economy*.

* Equal contribution.

Working Papers

- [1] Terrence Neumann and **Yan Leng**. Activation-Based Prompt Governance for LLM Agents in Complex Social Contexts.
- [2] **Yan Leng***, Leqi Liu*, and Yunxin Sang*. Too Much of a Good Thing? Managing Congestion from Decentralized AI Delegation. *INFORMS Data Science Workshop Best Paper Award Runner-up*.
- [3] **Yan Leng**. Governing Shared AI Systems: The Personalization–Consistency Frontier in Connected Knowledge Work.
- [4] **Yan Leng** and Wen Wang. Data Governance for Customer-Facing LLMs: Valuation and Selective Unlearning.
- [5] Yunxin Sang, **Yan Leng**, and Ashish Agarwal. User Perception Through LLM: A Theory-driven HyperGraph Framework for Marketing Content Generation. *INFORMS ISS Cluster Best Paper Award; INFORMS Data Science Workshop Best Student Paper Award (2024)*.
- [6] Junyu Cao* and **Yan Leng***. Learning to Optimize Data Quality for Crowdsourcing Labor Markets: A Human-Algorithm-Collaborative Framework. *INFORMS ISS Cluster Best Paper Award (2022)*.
- [7] **Yan Leng** and Ashish Agarwal. Are Spatial Neighbors Complements or Substitutes? Discovering a Visits-based Local Market Structure.
*Equal contribution.

Research Awards

- April 2026 CBA Foundation Research Excellence Award for Assistant Professors.
- Oct 2025 Best Paper Runner-up at INFORMS Data Science Workshop
- Jan 2025 Best Associate Editor for the ICIS 2024 Track: Data Analytics for Business and Societal Challenges
- Oct 2024 Best Student Paper Award at INFORMS Data Science Workshop.
- Nov 2022 Finalist for Meta People’s Expectations & Experiences with Digital Privacy Request for Proposals.
- Oct 2022 2022 INFORMS ISS Cluster Best Paper Award.
- June 2021 Second prize in INFORMS Revenue Management and Pricing Data-driven Challenge.

Grants

- Oct 2023 - Aug 2025 National Institutes of Health (NIH)’s AIM-AHEAD Consortium Development Program (Received a joint \$1,000,000 Grant with Prof. Ying Ding, Yifan Peng, Watkins Craig, and David Hodge).
- Feb 2022 - Aug 2024 National Science Foundation (NSF) CRII Award (\$154,231).
 - Jan 2026 Tinker research grant award (\$5,000).
 - Feb, 2025 Herb Kelleher Entrepreneurship Center (HKEC) Grant (\$5,000)
 - Feb, 2025 McCombs Research Excellence Grant (\$13,400)
- April 2024 OpenAI Researcher Access Program (\$5,000).
- Nov 2023 UT Austin Research & Creative Grants (\$9,860).
- Oct 2023 McCombs Research Excellence Grant (\$10,000).
- Oct 2023 Research Grant from Herb Kelleher Entrepreneurship Center (\$5,000).
- May 2023 Texas Global Faculty Research Seed Grants (\$10,000).
- March 2023 McCombs Research Excellence Grant (\$10,000).
 - Dec 2021 Marketing Science Institute Grant Award (\$15,000).
- March 2021 McCombs Research Excellence Grant (\$10,000).

Sep 2018 Russell Sage Foundation Grant Award (\$7,899).
Nov 2016 MIT IDEAS Global Challenge Grant (\$5,000).
Nov 2016 MIT Sandbox Innovation Fund (\$1,000).
Aug 2016 Harvard Sustainability Grant (\$1,000).

Teaching Awards

April 2026 McCombs BBA Faculty Honor Roll for Gen AI in Business and Social Sciences.
April 2025 McCombs BBA Faculty Honor Roll for Intro to Problem Solving and Programming.
April 2024 2023-2024 Trammell/CBA Foundation Teaching Award for Assistant Professors.
April 2024 McCombs BBA Faculty Honor Roll for Intro to Problem Solving and Programming.
Dec 2023 McCombs BBA Faculty Honor Roll for Intro to Problem Solving and Programming.
May 2021 McCombs BBA Faculty Honor Roll for Intro to Problem Solving and Programming.

Professional Service

2026- Associate Editor, Decision Sciences
2026- Guest Associate Editor, Information Systems Research
2026 Gold Reviewer, International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)
2025 - present Editorial Board Member, Information Systems Research
2025 Program Chair for INFORMS Data Science Workshop
2023, 2024 Associate Editor, International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)
2024 Ignite (Short Talk) Session Chairs for Workshop on Information Technologies and Systems (WITS)
2020 Local Chair for Workshop on Information Technologies and Systems (WITS)
2020- Reviewer for management journals, including Management Science, Information Systems Research, MIS Quarterly, Production and Operations Management (POMS)
2020- Reviewer for computer science conferences, including NeurIPS (Neural Information Processing Systems), ICML (International Conference on Machine Learning), The Web Conference (WWW), AAI (Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence)